FREE FAITH GUIDE

Fully *Family*

SIGNED AND FULLY FAMILY.



ROMANS 8

Chaotic Sunshine

Signed and fully *family.*

Everything for one honest conversation: the lesson, the back story, the questions, memory cards and a coloring page.

1 · LESSON RECAP
2 · BACK STORY
3 · TALK IT THROUGH
4 · MEMORY CARDS
5 · COLORING PAGE

LESSON RECAP

God forgave you, and then He signed the papers.

In Romans 8:12-17, Paul says the Spirit doesn't make you a slave to fear. It brings about your adoption and puts a family word in your mouth: "Abba, Father." In the Roman world, adoption was a legal act with teeth. In many cases old debts were canceled, the old name set aside, and the adoptee got full heir rights. In Christ, daughters get them too.

THE WORD AT THE HEART OF IT

Abba

ARAMAIC · AH-BAH

A family word of trust, used by children and grown children alike for a father they could count on. Jesus prayed it (Mark 14:36). The Spirit gives it to you (Galatians 4:6).

	What fear says	*What adoption says*
GOD	A boss to impress	"Abba, Father" (Romans 8:15)
YOU	A guest on a trial period	A child and an heir (8:16-17)
DEBT	Still paying it off	No condemnation (8:1)

"The Spirit you received does not make you slaves, so that you live in fear again; rather, the Spirit you received brought about your adoption to sonship. And by him we cry, 'Abba, Father.'"

ROMANS 8:15 · NIV

TAKE THIS HOME

Adopted, signed and fully family.

PLOT TWIST

Jesus prayed "Abba, Father" on His hardest night (Mark 14:36). Paul says the Spirit puts that same word in your heart (Galatians 4:6).

Start every prayer with "Father."

Meanwhile, in Rome...

LETTER ID CARD

Written by: Paul (Romans 1:1)
To: God's people in Rome (Romans 1:7)
When: mid-50s A.D., most scholars say
Format: a letter to a church living under Roman law

they knew what adoption meant.

What was going on

Paul writes to a church in the capital of an empire where adoption was a serious legal act. Romans 7 ends with a man wrestling with sin; Romans 8 opens with "no condemnation" (8:1).

In 8:12-17 Paul turns from debt to family: no obligation to the flesh (8:12), led by the Spirit (8:14), adopted (8:15), witnessed (8:16), heirs (8:17).

Read Romans 8:12-17 like a playlist

8:12-13
No debt to the old life.

8:14-15
Not slaves. "Abba, Father."

8:16
The Spirit testifies.

8:17
Heirs with Christ.

Why it matters

Bible teachers like William Barclay describe what Roman adoption did in many cases: old debts canceled, old name set aside, full heir rights, done before witnesses. Practice varied, but the picture holds.

Julius Caesar adopted Octavian in his will, and Octavian "took the name of Gaius Caesar" (Suetonius, Life of Augustus 7). New name, full inheritance.

SO WHAT?

You're not a guest on a trial period. You're family with papers.

Signed, sealed, staying.

A GENTLE WORD

If adoption is part of your story, or "father" is a hard word for you, every feeling is welcome at this table. God is the Father who does not fail, even where earthly fathers did. If someone is hurting you, getting safe comes first: National Domestic Violence Hotline 1-800-799-7233. In a crisis, call or text 988.

TALK IT THROUGH · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Pull up a chair.

BRING
A snack, a pen and your honest self.

WHO
3 to 8 friends. "Pass" is always allowed.

TABLE RULE
What's shared here stays here.

SPARK · 5 MIN

Who in your life feels like family, even without the same last name?

host goes first.

READ IT OUT LOUD · 5 MIN

Read **Romans 8:12-17** together. Listen for every family word: children, Father, heirs.

QUESTIONS · 25 MIN · START LIGHT, GO DEEPER

1. Finish this sentence: When I pray, the name I reach for first is ____, and that tells me…
2. Do you pray more like you're emailing a new client or calling your oldest friend? Why?
3. "Abba" is a family word of trust. What makes trust easy or hard for you?
4. Which of the four adoption gifts (debts canceled, new name, heir rights, a witness) do you most need to believe this week?

! **Deep End:** On a scale of 1 to 10, how much does fear still run your relationship with God? Where does it show up?

START WITH FATHER
Open every prayer today with "Father." Notice what happens in you.

SAY IT BACK
Out loud, once a day: "Adopted, signed and fully family."

CALL YOUR PERSON
Tell one friend she feels like family. No reason needed.

CLOSE IN PRAYER

Father, Your Spirit in us does not make us slaves to fear. You adopted us on purpose. Where earthly fathers fell short, be the Father who does not fail. Abba, Father, teach our hearts to mean it. Amen.

KEEP THE JOY COMING

Get the Sunshine Mail.

One Sunday a month: Scripture, an honest reflection, and a little room for surprises.

Share your table on Instagram **@chaoticsunshinetable**.

chaoticsunshine.com

SCAN TO SIGN UP

MEMORY VERSE

"The Spirit you received does not make you slaves, so that you live in fear again; rather, the Spirit you received brought about your adoption to sonship. And by him we cry, 'Abba, Father.'"

ROMANS 8:15 · NIV



MIRROR CARD

Adopted, *signed* and fully family.

ROMANS 8:15 · NIV

tape me where you get ready.

POCKET REMINDER

Start with Father.

This week: open every prayer with "Father," and notice where fear still has a vote.

start every prayer with "Father."

COLOR ME

Abba, Father

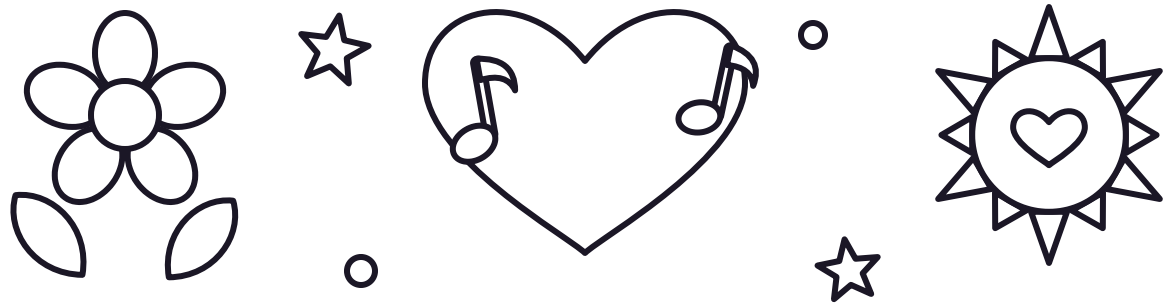
ROMANS 8:15 · NIV



Adopted, signed and fully family

...And by him we cry, 'Abba, Father.'

ROMANS 8:15 · NIV



Margin Notes

When I pray, the name I reach for first is:

Sunshine Mail

chaoticsunshine.com

CHAOTIC SUNSHINE